Portfolio

Guidelines for writing the portfolio for the course
***Introduction to Computational Methods for Digital Humanists* (summer semester 2027)**
by Dr. Svenja Guhr

In this class, one part of your performance is evaluated by the grade of the portfolio that you hand in by 15.07.2027. This portfolio is a collection of different writings that you produce over the semester and is related to the group project. It includes a theoretical embedding of your project by formulating a research question and hypothesis based in digital humanities research in the first part. Furthermore, you will describe your corpus, your metadata and your annotation guidelines in part two (see "demanded content"). The third part will be a reflection chapter on your personal learning progress.

What is the portfolio and what are the specific requirements for the portfolio for the examination in this class?

The portfolio, similar to a project report, is a piece of writing to be submitted at the end of the class to report on the successful course of your project, its outcome, and your personal development. Writing a portfolio will stay with you for the rest of your life. Whether you stay in academia and must write final portfolios or project reports for the FWF or for other third-party funding, or whether you go into business and are involved in projects and have to give an account at the end of the project term to explain why the project was successful or not successful, and what could be done better in the future. A portfolio serves to document and produce knowledge by reflecting on the course of your learning and the development of your project as well as analyzing the circumstances that ensured that you could complete the class successfully. It serves as a strategic tool for the continuous improvement of your learning.

The requirements for this portfolio have been adapted to the learning objectives of the module in the context of examination performance. It is therefore a modified form that links the different text types (abstract, scientific paper, reflection chapter).

To give you an insight into the structure and requirements of the portfolio that you must hand in for the examination, you will find a compilation of instructions for the structure, contents, and formal requirements of the portfolio on the following pages.

Formal requirements

Due to the great freedom of choice of topics and methods of analysis in the preparation of your group project, it is very important that you adhere to the following formal requirements regarding the portfolio that is the basis of your examination. I am aware that your creative freedom is restricted by the strict specifications. Nevertheless, this is the only way to ensure the comparability of individual assignments and a fair assessment.

Therefore, I ask you to adhere to the formalities so that I do not have to lower your grade.

The portfolio should have a length of **max. 10 pages.**

Figures, tables, or similar do not count towards the required text length, but only the pure continuous text. Please avoid using bullet points and lists of arguments; instead, formulate your thoughts in complete sentences. Please note that you will lose points for exceeding the number of pages (> 15% too many pages).

Cover page

- University, department, course name, and number, name of lecturer(s), date of submission, credit points to be achieved according to your examination regulations
- Name of author, matriculation number, email address, degree program with semester
- Portfolio "Title of your project" (not formulated as a question)
- Free choice of cover page style

The cover page is followed by a numbered table of contents with page numbers (starting with page “1” on the page with the “Research Question and Hypothesis…”).

Demanded content for this specific portfolio for examination:

Part 1: Research Question and Hypothesis
Part 2: Short Data Paper and Annotation Guidelines
- Abstract & Keywords
- Overview
- Method
- Dataset Description
- Reuse Potential
- References
- Annotation Guidelines

Part 3: Reflection Chapter

Format requirements for body text:

Page margin:	2 cm (to all sides, except left, as 2.5 cm)
Font size:	Headings: 14pt Main text: 12pt Footnotes: 10pt
Line spacing:	Main text: 1.5 times (relative) / 20pt (absolute) Footnotes: 1-times (relative) / 12pt (absolute)
Text typesetting:	justified (in main text and footnotes) please activate automatic hyphenation
Page numbering:	continuous page numbering page number at bottom right cover page and outline do not have page numbers page numbering starts with “Introduction” as page 1
Allowed typefaces: (only use one)	Arial, Calibri, Helvetica, Times, default font of TeX
Numbering:	Chapter numbering in Arabic numerals (e.g.: 2 ; 2.1 ; 2.1.1) number example sentences consecutively (Arabic numerals) number tables (Tab. 1) and graphs (Fig. 1) consecutively
Headings:	Each heading must be followed by at least three sentences of continuous text. If a chapter contains a subchapter (e.g., 2.1), there must be at least a second subchapter (2.1 + 2.2) Subchapters must not stand alone!

Part 1: Research Question and Hypothesis

(max. 500 words)

Please write a short text that introduces your research question and hypothesis and positions your research in the field of digital humanities. Please refer at least to the references that you read during the first few weeks of the class and add some information from the texts that you find in the reading list or recommended reading selection.

After reading the chapter, the reader should know:

What is the digital humanities subfield your research is positioned in and what has already been researched on your topic? What is your research question? What is your hypothesis and why do you think it is a reasonable one?

Part 2: Data Paper

The central part of the portfolio is the simulation of a data paper as it can be found as a paper type with the Journal of Open Humanities Data (JOHD).

On Moodle, you find some examples for data papers that were published with this journal. Please follow their submission guidelines for the next sections of your portfolio: “Short data papers contain a concise description of a humanities research object with high reuse potential. These are short (1000 words) highly structured narratives” (JOHD).

(0) Abstract

A short summary of the dataset being described: what the data covers, how it was collected, how it is stored, and a short description of its reuse potential. (ca. 100 words)

Keywords: keyword 1; keyword 2; lower case except names, max 6

(1) Overview

Repository location: Indicate where you stored your repository (corpus, annotated corpus, guidelines), i.e., in a GitHub repository.

Context – What kind of research project was this data produced as part of? (ca. 100 words)

Use sentences like:

"The focus of the project was on the…", "The research focused on how…", "The corpus was compiled in order to answer the research question…"

(2) Method – describe the methods used to create the dataset, including the following sub-headings (ca. 500 words):

Steps – The series of procedures followed to produce the dataset. This should include any source data used, as well as software and instrumentation involved.

Sampling strategy – If relevant, please outline the sampling strategy used to produce the data.

Quality control – If applicable. Please list the methods used for quality control in the production of the data (i.e., steps taken to normalize the data, evaluate the annotation, etc.).

(3) Dataset Description

Object name – Typically the name of the file or file set in the repository.

Format names and versions – E.g., ASCII, UTF-8, CSV, XML, TXT, HTML, JPEG, Excel, etc.

Creation dates – The start and end dates of when the data was created (YYYY-MM-DD).

Dataset creators – Please list anyone who helped to create the dataset (who may or may not be an author of the data paper), including their roles (using and affiliations).

Language – Languages used in the dataset (i.e., for variable names, etc.)

License – The open license under which the data has been deposited (e.g., CC0).

Repository name – The name of the repository to which the data is uploaded. E.g., GAMS, etc.

Publication date – If already known, the date in which the dataset was published in the repository.

You can also add tables or visualizations to describe your dataset.

(4) Reuse Potential – Please describe the ways in which your data could be reused by other researchers both within and outside of your field. For example, this might include aggregation, further analysis, reference, validation, teaching or collaboration. This section should also include limitations to, or potential barriers for reuse. (ca. 300 words)

Unnumbered chapter of the data paper: Bibliography, list of references and sources

Recommendation: Use one of the literature management programs such as Zotero, Citavi and co. They simplify the correct creation of bibliographies and reference lists. Please make sure that all sources/references you mention in your portfolio are also to be found in the bibliography. Please constantly use one of the common citation styles (Harvard citation style preferred) and avoid changes between styles and irregularities. Please do not forget to manually review your list of references at the end and correct any irregularities that may have occurred. Remember to sort the sources alphabetically by the last name of the first author.

Please add only those references to your bibliography that you have used for writing the portfolio. The list should not be a bibliography in which you list every work that fits the topic, but only the ones you used.

Annotation Guidelines

Write your annotation guidelines according to the *Instructions for Creating Annotation Guidelines* by Reiter & Guhr (2025).

Part 3: Reflection chapter

(ca. 1000 words - important part of the examination!)

The aim of the reflection chapter is to reflect critically on your role as a participant in a group project. Please reflect on the implementation of the project, on your own role in the project as well as on the challenges you faced.

Some guiding questions for orientation:

- What personal experiences did you have during the project implementation?
- What did you learn during the group project and the class in general?
- How did the group meetings go? Did you feel that you had a specific role in the project group?
- What was your individual contribution to the project?
- What difficulties did you personally have in carrying out the project?
- How did you identify problems and deal with confronting challenges?
- How did you deal with your own knowledge gaps?
- How did you cope with the digital methods and resources used?
- Were you able to fully comprehend the analyses carried out immediately?
- How did you proceed in order to fully comprehend the analyses and be able to repeat them?
- How did you contribute to the poster creation and presentation?
- How do you reflect on your personal contribution to the project and the presentation?
- What is your conclusion on your learning progress in this semester's course?

Declaration, citation and use of AI

End your portfolio with the following declaration, your name and the date: “I declare that I have written this portfolio independently, that I have used only the sources and aids indicated, and that I have marked all quotations and paraphrases. I have documented my use of AI tools below.” Cite according to common academic standards and use Harvard short references in the text (Name YYYY: page), with a full bibliography at the end.

AI tools may be used as described in the course description (for example for language editing, debugging code, or as part of the annotation exercises). Briefly document which tools you used, and for what, in a short paragraph after the declaration. You remain responsible for the content.

Note on the use of sources

1) Please pay attention to the scientific nature of the sources and secondary literature you use. Just because a statement is made in a book or on a website (even supposedly by an expert), it should not be taken as an unreflected truth. So always pay attention to the source of the information you want to use in your project and report and treat it critically with a view to further research.

2) Duden, student encyclopedias, teacher information pages, Wikipedia articles and the like are not sources you should use in a scientific text.

3) Please avoid plagiarism, copy and paste attempts, etc. - You know what I mean! If I find such an attempt of cheating, I will have to grade your research report with 5,0 and report you to the university. Since nobody wants that, please work scientifically clean. Reusing text passages already submitted in other examinations in the new paper (self-plagiarism) also counts as attempted cheating and will be punished accordingly.

Submission of the portfolio

Please submit your portfolio digitally and on time (by 15.07.2027, 23:59(AoE)) as one(!) PDF file via Moodle. There will be no extension of the deadline!

Final notes

This guide does not, of course, cover everything that needs to be considered when writing a portfolio but serves merely as an overview and orientation. As with everything, this individually summarized advice does not represent the one and only truth but must always be treated as an interpretation. Please keep an eye out for possible updates to this guide and check for any updates I may have uploaded to Moodle before submitting your portfolio.

Please email me if you are having difficulties writing the portfolio that I could help you with, if there is any ambiguity in the implementation of the guidelines.